First Decision by Day 90

How I'd run technology enablement governance

> Governance fails when it becomes a reporting factory. It works when it forces clear, accountable decisions. Here's how I'd get to the first one by Day 90.

DAYS 1–30 · DIAGNOSE

Diagnose and set decision rights

Everyone knows who owns the yes and the no.

- A portfolio inventory with sponsor, stage, budget exposure and risk tier.
- A decision rights matrix for scope, budget, schedule, risk acceptance and go-live.
- A forum design: which body decides what, who attends, and how often.

Output: Steering 1 approves the charter and decision rights. Decision Log #001.

DAYS 31–60 · OPERATE

Establish the operating rhythm

One version of the truth, and status nobody has to argue about.

- Stoplight status (green, yellow, red) set by thresholds, not judgment calls.
- Escalation thresholds published before anyone needs them.
- An issue-routing ladder, so each problem lands at the lowest level that can solve it.

Output: Steering 2 makes the first cross-program trade-off. Decision Log #005.

DAYS 61–90 · DECIDE

Executive readout and adoption baseline

Leadership makes the call with evidence, not optimism.

- A one-page executive view that opens with the decision needed.
- An enablement scorecard that keeps delivery, adoption and operations separate.
- Go-live readiness criteria, signed by the business owner, not IT.

Output: The Executive Readout makes one call per program: proceed, pivot, slow or stop. Decision Log #007.

THE DAY 60 TRADE-OFF (ILLUSTRATIVE)

Programs B and C both need the 6-person integration team in Weeks 10–15: 960 + 720 hours against 1,440 available, a 240-hour shortfall.

Options: sequence (C slips, audit risk), phase scope (B launches core scope, C does audit-critical work first), or add capacity (about $72K, over the 10% threshold).

Decision #005: phase scope. Both external commitments hold at no added cost, with a 180-hour buffer and a contractor fallback to decide by Day 74.

OPERATING PRINCIPLES

- **Decisions over reporting.** Every forum exists to decide something. If it doesn't, it gets cut.
- **Objective status.** Colors come from thresholds, not from how the week felt.
- **Escalate before the slip.** Conflicts reach the people who can resolve them while there are still options.
- **Adoption is the finish line.** A system is done when people use it, not when it goes live.

WHAT YOU'D RECEIVE

Sponsor	The executive one-pager and decision-ready options
Delivery owner	Clear thresholds and fast escalation paths
Shared-resource owner	Early warning of conflicts, and no surprise demands
Control owner	Evidence before go-live, not after
Business owner	The readiness checklist and the adoption scorecard

WORKING AGREEMENT

- Nothing goes red without going yellow first.
- Risks reach the sponsor the day they cross a threshold.
- Decisions are logged and sent within 24 hours.
- No meeting without a decision on the agenda.
- One status format, with one set of color definitions, for every program.

I'd propose we agree on: Decision turnaround times by severity, for example 48 hours on critical-path items; a named delegate who can decide when you can't attend; pre-reads read before the meeting, so the meeting is spent deciding.

> A recommendation should change when the evidence changes. Accountability for delivery should not.

All programs, people, figures and decisions on this page are illustrative. They show a method, not a description of any real organization or engagement. The plan is a starting hypothesis I would test against the real portfolio in the first 30 days.